

Best desert air coolers

TOP PICKS FOR POWERFUL SUMMER COOLING

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As the summer season is here, I wanted to buy a desert air cooler for my room. I have an air conditioner in my room, and it is effective, but ACs are expensive to buy and run. In many parts of India, especially dry regions like Delhi, in the following few months, a powerful desert cooler can deliver strong cooling at a fraction of the cost. During my childhood, we used to have massive metallic boxes as a cooler. But now you can get good air coolers that can be used within the room. They will come in large tank sizes and offer strong airflow. And still be portable to move between rooms if needed. Here are our top air cooler picks for a budget of Rs 10,000.

Bajaj 85X 85L desert air cooler

Key features: 85L tank | Honeycomb pads | 4000 CMH air flow | Ice chamber | Inverter compatible

The Bajaj 85X is one of the most popular desert coolers in this price segment. It comes with an 85 litre water tank, which allows long cooling sessions without frequent refilling.

The cooler uses honeycomb cooling pads. These pads have a layered structure that holds water for longer periods and improves evaporation. As hot air passes through the wet pads, the evaporation process removes heat and cools the air.

The cooler also delivers strong airflow with a large fan and high air delivery of about 2350 Cubic Feet Per Minute (CFM). This circulates air effectively across medium to large rooms.

Another useful feature is the ice chamber. You can add ice cubes to the chamber, which lowers the temperature of the water inside the cooler. This can provide slightly colder air during hot afternoons.

It also supports inverter operation, which means the cooler can continue running during power cuts without drawing excessive electricity.

Price: ₹9,999

Voltas 90L desert air cooler

Key features: 90L tank | 3 side honeycomb pads | Ice chamber | Thermal overload protection

Voltas's large 90L tank could offer longer cooling cycles with less frequent refilling. It sports an air delivery rate of 1895 CFM and an air throw range of 55 ft. It supports a coverage area of 890 sq.ft.

The cooler uses three side honeycomb cooling pads. Having pads on three sides increases the surface area for evaporation. This allows the cooler to pull in more hot air and convert it into cooler air before pushing it into the room.

It also features thermal overload protection. This is a safety feature that automatically shuts down the

motor if it overheats due to voltage fluctuations or prolonged usage.

You get a 1-year domestic warranty on this.

Price: ₹9,999

Kenstar Farrata HC 100L desert air cooler

Key features: 100L tank | Honeycomb pads | Large fan blade | Strong 4200 CFM air delivery

The Kenstar 100L cooler focuses on strong airflow of 4200 CFM, 40 ft air throw distance, and efficient cooling pads.

It uses honeycomb pads that improve evaporation efficiency compared to older wood wool pads.

The cooler also uses a large fan blade to move a higher volume of air across the room. It works within a 470 sq ft coverage area. You'll get a 1-year warranty on the product.

Price: ₹9,999

Crompton Ozone Neo 95L desert air cooler

Key features: 95L tank | Everlast pump | Honeycomb pads | 1648 CFM High air delivery

The Crompton Ozone Neo is a well-known option in the desert cooler segment. It comes with a 95 litre tank and strong 4-way airflow.

A key feature here is the Everlast pump. Water pumps in coolers can sometimes fail due to mineral deposits in hard water. Crompton's Everlast pump is designed to handle